Privacy is becoming a condition for crypto adoption, and UR puts Bittensor in the network layer

Crypto now carries enough ordinary economic activity that a public ledger has become a commercial barrier.

Encryption hides what was sent, but the connection still shows who sent it. SN25 turns that missing layer into a commodity that anyone can supply and the network prices in TAO.

What could break it

New enforcement against privacy developers, and fees that accrue to issuers and applications rather than network tokens.

Stablecoins now sit on ledgers anyone can read. Multicoin counted more than $310 billion in stablecoin supply and $121 billion in DeFi in February 2026. *p. 4*

That exposes companies, and AI makes it cheap to exploit. A month of onchain payments shows a competitor payroll, suppliers, customers and treasury moves. *p. 5–6*

The case for privacy is now commercial as well as ideological. Buterin and Durov reach the same conclusion, and US policy has moved from sanctions to stablecoin law. *p. 7–8*

Markets and companies are already paying for it. ZEC rerated in 2025 and a quarter of its supply is now shielded; Zama, Bron and Dfns report live payment and trading deployments. *p. 10–11*

All of it leaks at the network layer, where few projects work. Only UR and Nym, of the 12 projects we track, protect who is talking to whom. *p. 12–13*

UR's thesis works if operator fees replace emissions. SN25 prices routing capacity as a digital commodity; the test is whether privacy operators pay for it before emissions fall. *p. 15–19*

Sources: Multicoin Capital, 2026 investment thesis (Feb 2026); Zama and Bron; Dfns and Zama; a16z, Investing in Nym; UR, subnet design and implementation. Company-reported deployments are not independently verified.